

NICK WALLER

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ENTERPRISE TECHNOLOGY & GAMING OPERATIONS EXECUTIVE

Global IT Operations | Loyalty Ecosystems | Digital Transformation

Strategic, forward-thinking IT Director with progressive leadership experience driving enterprise IT strategy, gaming technology operations, infrastructure modernization, and large-scale digital transformation initiatives across highly regulated casino and hospitality environments. Proven success delivering scalable enterprise ecosystems that unify loyalty, transactional, operational, and customer data to improve business intelligence, operational visibility, guest engagement, and revenue performance across global organizations. Recognized for leading high-performing technical organizations responsible for enterprise applications, infrastructure operations, cybersecurity compliance, software release governance, and mission-critical gaming systems supporting 24/7 revenue-critical environments.

Adept at aligning technology roadmaps with business growth objectives, translating complex technical concepts into measurable operational outcomes, and building strong partnerships across executive leadership, engineering, operations, and customer-facing teams. Known for developing accountable, execution-focused teams that balance operational stability, innovation, customer experience, and long-term scalability. Brings a unique blend of strategic leadership, technical depth, operational discipline, and business acumen to enterprise-scale gaming, hospitality, and technology organizations.

Notable Career Highlights

- Delivered more than 15 global gaming and loyalty platform launches that generated over \$10M in revenue across international casino markets.
- Reduced enterprise operational expenses by more than 28% while modernizing infrastructure, improving vendor value, and enhancing operational performance.
- Directed enterprise technology operations supporting 13 casino properties, 25 hotels, and more than 180 retail and hospitality locations.
- Led full IT deployment and systems integration for a large-scale casino resort opening supporting more than 2,400 employees and revenue-critical gaming operations.
- Achieved 100% audit readiness across PCI-DSS, SOC 2, AML, and gaming regulatory compliance initiatives.
- Improved ticket response and resolution times by 80% within 60 days through SLA governance, operational redesign, and service delivery optimization.
- Led globally distributed technology teams across North America, Asia, Australia, and South Africa supporting enterprise platform delivery and operational consistency.
- Directed enterprise infrastructure and operational environments supporting more than 1,800 slot machines, large-scale hospitality systems, and high-volume entertainment venues.

Areas of Expertise

Enterprise Technology Leadership: Enterprise IT Strategy | Business Strategy Alignment | Global Technology Operations | Digital Transformation | Enterprise Platform Delivery | Enterprise Architecture | Organizational Leadership | Executive Stakeholder Engagement | Operational Excellence | Team Development, Mentorship & Coaching

Technology Strategy, Governance & Planning: Technology Governance | Technology Planning | IT Operating Model Design | Operating Model Optimization | Technology Roadmap Development | Release Governance | Change Management | IT Service Delivery | Risk Management | Compliance-Driven Technology Operations

Gaming, Hospitality & Loyalty Technology: Casino Gaming Systems | Loyalty & Player Engagement Platforms | Hospitality Technology Ecosystems | Hotel & Resort Systems | Guest Experience Technologies | Venue & Entertainment Systems | Property Openings & Technology Deployments

Data, Infrastructure & Enterprise Platforms: Enterprise Data Platforms | Data Integration & APIs | Enterprise Data Warehousing (EDW) | Real-Time Data Processing | Cloud & Hybrid Infrastructure | Virtualization Technologies | High Availability & Disaster Recovery | Infrastructure Modernization | Scalable Platform Architecture

Governance, Security & Service Delivery: Cybersecurity & Regulatory Compliance | PCI-DSS | SOC 2 | AML | Change & Release Management | Incident & Problem Management | Vendor & Contract Negotiations | Budgeting & Cost Optimization | IT Service Delivery

Program & Operational Management: Program & Portfolio Leadership | Enterprise Implementations | M&A Systems Integration | Resource Planning | Continuous Improvement | Operational Scaling | Business Process Optimization | Cross-Functional Collaboration

Technical Skills

AWS | Azure | Google Cloud Platform (GCP) | VMware | Cisco UCS | HPE 3PAR | Enterprise Networking | Infrastructure Architecture | APIs & Enterprise Integrations | EDW & Data Pipelines | ServiceNow | Jira | ClickUp | Monday.com | Smartsheet | Power BI | Microsoft 365 | Commercial A/V Systems | Access Control Technologies | Endpoint Security | Perforce | Unity3D | Unreal Engine | Windows | macOS | SQL / SSMS | PostMan | SoapUI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

LIGHT & WONDER, Las Vegas, NV

(06/2023 – 05/2026)

Director of Information Technology Management

Global enterprise gaming and loyalty platforms supporting international casino deployments and 24/7 operational environments.

Directed global delivery, governance, and operational strategy for enterprise gaming and loyalty technology platforms supporting large-scale casino operators across multiple international markets. Provided executive leadership across platform architecture, enterprise integrations, software release management, cybersecurity compliance, and high-availability infrastructure initiatives in complex 24/7 gaming environments.

- Led global delivery of enterprise gaming and loyalty platforms across multiple regions, enabling data-driven customer engagement, personalization, and operational intelligence for casino operators worldwide.
- Directed architecture and implementation of enterprise data ecosystems, including APIs, replicated databases, and EDW pipelines, ensuring scalability, interoperability, and reliable cross-system integration.
- Enabled real-time and near-real-time enterprise data flows supporting customer activity tracking, loyalty engagement, operational reporting, and business analytics across distributed environments.
- Oversaw over 15 global platform launches that generated more than \$10M in revenue while maintaining high standards for system reliability, deployment accuracy, and data integrity.
- Established enterprise software release governance standards and implemented an internal release management platform that improved deployment visibility, strengthened traceability, and reduced operational risk across more than 10 active code branches.
- Partnered closely with engineering, infrastructure, and customer IT leadership teams to align platform delivery with HA/DR requirements, scalability objectives, and long-term operational strategies.
- Served as a strategic liaison between technical and executive stakeholders, translating complex platform capabilities into measurable business outcomes and operational improvements.
- Led globally distributed teams across North America, Asia, Australia, and South Africa, driving standardized delivery practices and execution consistency across international deployments.
- Implemented enterprise-wide cybersecurity and regulatory compliance frameworks aligned with NIGC, PCI-DSS, SOC 2, and AML standards, achieving 100% audit readiness and strengthening protection of sensitive gaming and financial data.
- Delivered operational cost optimization initiatives through vendor negotiations, resource alignment, and governance improvements while maintaining service quality and delivery timelines.

HARD ROCK INTERNATIONAL/SEMINOLE GAMING

(05/2019 – 05/2023)

IT Manager of Gaming Applications – Seminole Hard Rock Support Services, Davie, FL; 05/2022 – 05/2023

Enterprise gaming, hospitality, and loyalty operations supporting 13 casino properties and 25 hotels.

Provided enterprise leadership for gaming application support operations across a large multi-property hospitality and casino portfolio. Directed service delivery, application stability, operational governance, and large-scale system initiatives supporting mission-critical gaming, loyalty, and guest engagement platforms.

- Directed enterprise support operations for 13 casino properties, 25 hotels, and more than 180 retail and café locations, ensuring high availability of gaming and loyalty systems across the organization.
- Led and developed a team of more than 15 IT professionals responsible for application support, deployment activities, testing, escalation management, and operational service delivery.
- Reduced ticket response and resolution times by 80% within 60 days by implementing SLA governance frameworks, ServiceNow reporting dashboards, and streamlined operational workflows.

- Managed enterprise upgrades, feature deployments, and system rollouts across multiple properties while minimizing downtime and maintaining regulatory compliance.
- Played a key leadership role in the integration of The Mirage acquisition in Las Vegas, aligning legacy gaming, loyalty, and supporting enterprise systems within the broader Hard Rock ecosystem.
- Partnered with business leadership, vendors, and technical teams to deliver scalable, high-availability application services aligned with operational and guest experience objectives.
- Oversaw incident, escalation, and change management processes, improving platform stability, governance consistency, and regulatory compliance in highly controlled gaming environments.
- Drove continuous improvement initiatives that standardized support processes, increased operational efficiency, and enhanced overall service quality across the enterprise.

IT Operations Manager/Senior System Administrator – Hard Rock Hotel & Casino Sacramento, Wheatland, CA;
05/2019 – 05/2022

Large-scale casino resort operations supporting gaming, hospitality, entertainment, and corporate infrastructure environments.

Directed enterprise IT operations, infrastructure strategy, and large-scale technology initiatives for a high-volume casino resort environment supporting gaming, hospitality, entertainment, and corporate operations. Managed multimillion-dollar budgets, cross-functional technical teams, and mission-critical systems in a 24/7 regulated environment.

- Directed enterprise IT operations for an over 2,400 employee casino resort, ensuring reliability, scalability, and compliance across all technology services and business units.
- Managed \$2.5M in CapEx and reduced OpEx spending from \$2.5M to \$1.8M through vendor optimization, contract negotiations, and strategic technology investments while improving end-user value and maintaining strong vendor relationships.
- Led a more than 10-member cross-functional IT team responsible for Help Desk, networking, systems administration, and enterprise infrastructure support.
- Supported mission-critical technology operations for over 1,800 slot machines, over 60 table games, an over 200 room hotel tower, multiple food and beverage venues, and a large-scale entertainment environment.
- Spearheaded the full IT deployment and launch of the property, overseeing enterprise system integrations, virtualization buildouts, network architecture, and infrastructure implementation across MDF/IDF environments.
- Directed major technology initiatives supporting expansion projects, including Hard Rock Live, Rocktane Gas Station with integrated loyalty payment systems, and additional administrative and regulatory facilities.
- Administered enterprise infrastructure consisting of more than 260 servers operating within UCS and 3PAR environments, ensuring high availability, redundancy, and long-term scalability.
- Delivered measurable operational improvements through modernization initiatives, infrastructure enhancements, and deployment of advanced enterprise technologies that improved uptime and operational efficiency.

DROCK GAMING, LLC, Las Vegas, NV

(01/2017 – 05/2019)

Systems Administrator, A/V Systems Programmer – The D Las Vegas Casino Hotel

Supported enterprise infrastructure, systems administration, and commercial audiovisual technologies. Contributed to operational stability, technology modernization, and guest-facing entertainment systems supporting 24/7 business operations.

- Administered enterprise IT infrastructure, systems, and end-user technologies supporting casino, hospitality, and back-office operations.
- Supported commercial audiovisual systems programming, deployment, and maintenance for entertainment venues, guest experience technologies, and operational communications systems.
- Assisted with infrastructure upgrades, system troubleshooting, and technology enhancement initiatives that improved operational reliability and service continuity.

EDUCATION / PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

B.S. (Bachelor of Science), Game Design & Development, FULL SAIL UNIVERSITY, Winter Park, FL

Professional development includes enterprise IT leadership, gaming systems operations, infrastructure management, cybersecurity and compliance readiness, platform governance, hospitality technology ecosystems, and emerging AI-enabled business and operational technologies.